MONTHLY UPDATE

Zambia: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16-3 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies · Legislation and regulation · Data protection · Standards · Public debate and participation in policymaking

Strategies, plans and policies

GROW ZAMBIA AGENDA 2026-2031

- **Zambia places ICT at centre of new economic blueprint** — CAJ News Africa, 10 September 2026

  The Smart Zambia Institute, the government's e-government agency, endorsed President Hakainde Hichilema's Grow Zambia Agenda 2026–2031, which carries eight national targets on digital infrastructure, CAJ News reported on 10 September 2026. National coordinator Percy Chinyama said the institute is building a real-time dashboard reporting progress on all targets to Cabinet, and is digitising 2.5 million smallholder farmers under the National Farmer Registry.

FRAMEWORK FOR CONTENT-CREATOR EARNINGS FROM DIGITAL PLATFORMS

- **Zambia unlocks digital earnings for creators** — ITWeb Africa, 12 October 2026

  Zambia's technology and youth ministries are developing a framework for local content creators to earn from digital platforms, and are talking to Meta, TikTok and Google about the legal and technical arrangements. The President named it a priority when opening the 14th National Assembly, and a national database of creators is being compiled.

Legislation and regulation

REVOCATION OF AN OPERATOR'S LICENCES

- **ZICTA kicks out Zedmobile from Zambia's telecom market over regulatory non-compliance** — Zambia Monitor, 15 September 2026

  The communications regulator revoked an operator's network and service licences with effect from 14 September, citing persistent failures to meet regulatory, operational and financial obligations after considering the operator's representations.

ELECTRONIC COMMUNICATIONS AND TRANSACTIONS ACT NO. 4 OF 2021

- **Gov't Reviews Electronic Communications and Transactions Act** — Efficacy News, 30 September 2026

> Zambia's technology ministry opened stakeholder consultations on amending the Electronic Communications and Transactions Act of 2021, approved in principle by Cabinet in September 2025. The changes would strengthen the national public key infrastructure under ZICTA and add appeal mechanisms.

Data protection

> NATIONAL CHILD ONLINE PROTECTION STRATEGY 2025-2029

- **Zambia launches Child Justice Week 2026 with a call to strengthen protection of children in digital spaces** — UNICEF Zambia, 7 October 2026

  Zambia's technology and science permanent secretary Brilliant Habeenzu launched Child Justice Week 2026 in Lusaka on 7 October under the theme of protecting children in digital spaces. UNICEF and Lifeline/ChildLine Zambia reported 1,208 online-safety calls and cases from January to August 2026, 85% involving children, citing addiction, harassment, cyberbullying and sextortion.

Standards

> STANDARDS TECHNICAL COOPERATION AGREEMENT WITH RWANDA

- **Zambia, Rwanda sign technical cooperation agreement to harmonise standards** — Zambia Monitor, 3 September 2026 RWANDA

  The Zambia Bureau of Standards and the Rwanda Standards Board signed a technical cooperation agreement at the 32nd African Organisation for Standardisation General Assembly in Mombasa. It covers information exchange, joint technical committees, mutual recognition of standards and conformity assessment results, and support in standards development.

> NATIONAL PUBLIC KEY INFRASTRUCTURE AND DIGITAL TRUST ANCHOR

- **Zambia Bets on Digital Trust** — Zambia24, 7 September 2026

  The communications regulator has operationalised the National Digital Trust Anchor as national root certification authority, under the electronic communications and transactions statute. The framework is to issue and verify the certificates and signatures that establish who a person or organisation is online. No certificate count, list of subordinate authorities or accreditation route accompanies the launch.

- **Zambia launches national digital trust infrastructure** — ITWeb Africa, 9 September 2026

  Zambia and Altron Security have launched a National Public Key Infrastructure, intended as a sovereign root of trust for digital identity, electronic signatures and secure online government, with certificates carrying legal validity under the country's electronic communications and transactions law. The master cryptographic keys were generated under independently audited conditions in a purpose-built facility and are held offline, split among several custodians so that no single body controls them. The Smart Zambia Institute's national coordinator said the launch is only the beginning and its value depends on whether government can sustain the infrastructure, fund it and get public institutions to adopt it.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

> PROSECUTION OF ONLINE SPEECH UNDER THE CYBER SECURITY AND CYBER CRIMES ACT 2021

- **Court convicts vlogger Chishimba over Mwanawasa allegations** — Mwebantu, 11 September 2026

  A Lusaka magistrate convicted vlogger Joseph Chishimba on 11 September 2026 under section 54 of Zambia's Cyber Security and Cyber Crimes Act 2021 for forwarding to a WhatsApp group, in October 2024, a screenshot making allegations about presidential aide Chipokota Mwanawasa. The court found forensic evidence showed it was sent from his phone, though the post itself was not recovered. Sentencing was adjourned.

- **Mansa tailor nabbed for insulting HH on TikTok** — News Diggers, 12 September 2026

  Police in Mansa arrested a 38-year-old man over a TikTok video allegedly insulting President Hakainde Hichilema, charging him under Zambia's Cyber Crimes Act with harassment using electronic gadgets. The police statement is dated 11 September 2026, after the Secretary to the Cabinet warned that insulting the President would be prosecuted.

- **Vlogger gets 9 months for sharing screenshot about Mwanawasa's false pregnancy** — News Diggers, 15 September 2026

  A Lusaka magistrate sentenced vlogger Joseph Chishimba to nine months on 15 September 2026, four days after convicting him under section 54 of Zambia's Cyber Security and Cyber Crimes Act 2021. He had posted to a WhatsApp group in October 2024 a screenshot of a Facebook post making claims about Chipo Mwanawasa.

- **Police nab TikToker for saying truck drivers steal fuel, have poor hygiene** — News Diggers, 19 September 2026

  Police in Ndola, Zambia, arrested a 24-year-old TikToker, Natasha Nambeya, for allegedly harassing truck drivers, after a trustee of the Truck Drivers Association of Zambia complained about videos accusing drivers of stealing fuel and poor hygiene.

Finance

New investments

New investments

DIGITAL ZAMBIA ACCELERATION PROJECT

- **IDEA Half-Year Implementation Progress Report: January-June 2026 and Outlook for July-December 2026** — COMESA Secretariat (IDEA project), 1 October 2026 ANGOLA DRC MALAWI ESWATINI EAST AFRICA SOUTHERN AFRICA

  COMESA's half-year progress report on the World Bank-financed Inclusive Digitalisation in Eastern and Southern Africa programme, a US$2.48 billion envelope, covers January to June 2026 in Angola, the DRC, Malawi, Zambia and Eswatini. The COMESA secretariat had spent 9% of its US$3.71 million 2026 budget by June, and moved its AI and regional digital inclusion consultancies from procurement to implementation.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Connectivity

MOBILE AND MOBILE INTERNET SUBSCRIPTIONS

- **Giving business and citizens a smart edge** — Freight News, 3 September 2026

  A Freight News feature on Zambia's National Digital Strategy 2023–27 quotes the World Bank's Paul Ndungutse on ZamPortal services such as road fitness certificates, immigration and land services. Citing an April 2026 Presidential Delivery Unit statement, it reports 95% mobile population coverage and internet subscriptions rising from 10.4 million in 2021 to 14.7 million in 2025.

- **Govt seeks Tech partnerships to build local capacity** — Lusaka Times, 18 September 2026

Zambia's Ministry of Technology and Science told a visiting Hikvision delegation that technology partnerships must include skills transfer, local value retention and compliance with Zambian law. It said internet subscriptions rose from 10.4 million to 14.68 million between 2021 and 2025, fibre coverage grew from about 15,000 to over 42,000 km, and mobile money transactions rose from K169 billion in 2021 to K486 billion in 2024.

AIRTEL ZAMBIA ACQUISITION OF AIRTEL TELESONIC FIBRE NETWORK

- **Airtel invests K324m in 1,300km optic fibre network** — Zambian Business Times, 21 September 2026

  Airtel Zambia is acquiring about 1,300 km of fibre-optic infrastructure from its related company Airtel Telesonic Zambia for K324.9 million, the Zambian Business Times reported on 21 September 2026. The deal is classed as a small related-party transaction, equal to 1.40% of Airtel Zambia's market value.

DPI

Data Exchange · Digital Identity and CRVS · Digital Payments and Fintech · Registries · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

Data Exchange

REGIONAL CUSTOMS-TO-CUSTOMS DATA EXCHANGE ROADMAP

- **Five Southern African countries move to link customs data as trade corridors face pressure to cut delays** — Southern African Times, 2 September 2026 MALAWI MOZAMBIQUE SOUTH AFRICA ZIMBABWE SOUTHERN AFRICA

  Customs administrations of Malawi, Mozambique, South Africa, Zambia and Zimbabwe adopted a roadmap and action plan for customs-to-customs data exchange at a meeting in Pretoria on 24-26 August 2026, hosted by the South African Revenue Service and convened by TradeMark Africa. The aim is to share trade data before consignments reach the border, building on existing Zambia-Malawi and Zambia-Zimbabwe links.

AFRICA ACCELERATOR FOR DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE (AA4DPI)

- **CDPI on its session at the Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, 2–3 September 2026** — Centre for Digital Public Infrastructure (CDPI), 3 September 2026 ETHIOPIA MALAWI RWANDA SIERRA LEONE

  The Centre for Digital Public Infrastructure led a session at the Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, hosted by UNDP and the Centre for Open Societal Systems on 2 and 3 September 2026. Delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia covered DPI blueprints, verifiable credentials, consented data sharing and reusable open-source code.

- **Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure (AA4DPI)** — United Nations Development Programme, 8 September 2026 AFRICA

  UNDP has published the standing description of its Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, led jointly by the Regional Bureau for Africa and the Digital and AI Hub, which supports countries to assess digital readiness, strengthen governance, build implementation capacity and develop investment-ready programmes across digital identity, digital payments and data exchange. Its first published cohort session ran on 2 and 3 September with delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia; no budget, duration or deliverable set is published for the accelerator itself.

- **UNDP's AA4DPI Programme Deepens South-South Cooperation on Digital Public Infrastructure** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), 8 September 2026 ETHIOPIA MALAWI RWANDA SIERRA LEONE AFRICA

  Delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia, with African Union representatives, concluded a two-week South-South learning mission to India on digital public infrastructure. Convened under UNDP's newly launched Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, it took delegates through New Delhi, Pune and Bengaluru to examine India's digital identity, payment and data exchange systems.

GOVERNMENT SERVICE BUS

- **IDEA Half-Year Implementation Progress Report: January-June 2026 and Outlook for July-December 2026** — COMESA Secretariat (IDEA project), 1 October 2026 ANGOLA DRC MALAWI ESWATINI EAST AFRICA SOUTHERN AFRICA

  Summarised under New investments.

COMESA YELLOW CARD ONLINE SALE PILOT

- **Digital overhaul targets fraud in Sh3.5bn cross-border motor insurance market** — Business Daily (Nation Media Group), 13 October 2026 EAST AFRICA SOUTHERN AFRICA

  COMESA's Yellow Card cross-border motor insurance scheme is piloting online sale of cover in Zambia in 2026 and expanding phone-based certificate verification, now used in eight countries, through data sharing between members, Business Daily reported on 13 October 2026. The scheme issued more than 340,000 cards in 2025, worth about US$27 million (Sh3.5 billion) in premiums.

Digital Identity and CRVS

INVALIDATION OF THE NATIONAL IDENTITY DOCUMENTS OF GOVERNMENT CRITICS

- **Njapau Defends Invalidation Of IDs, Names HH's Online Attackers** — Lusaka Times, 19 September 2026

  Former Zambian deputy home affairs minister Grace Njapau defended the government's invalidation of national identity documents held by people she accused of an online campaign against President Hakainde Hichilema, naming Emmanuel Mwamba, JJ Banda, Sishuwa Sishuwa and Lillian Mutambo. The number affected, who among them is included and the legal process used are not stated; no government statement is cited.

MOSIP-BASED NATIONAL DIGITAL ID SYSTEM

- **IDEA Half-Year Implementation Progress Report: January-June 2026 and Outlook for July-December 2026** — COMESA Secretariat (IDEA project), 1 October 2026 ANGOLA DRC MALAWI ESWATINI EAST AFRICA SOUTHERN AFRICA

  Summarised under New investments.

Digital Payments and Fintech

AUTOMATED MONITORING OF MOBILE MONEY AGENT ACTIVITY AND LIQUIDITY

- **African mobile money shifts beyond adoption** — TechTrendsKE, 4 September 2026 GHANA

  MTN mobile money executives told the group's fintech summit in Johannesburg that high adoption numbers mask weak use of savings and investment products. The Ghanaian chief executive said the platform processes more than 26 million transactions a day but that fewer than 0.3% of users actively invest; the Zambian chief executive said agent numbers were not on their own solving access and that the company had deployed artificial intelligence to monitor agent activity and liquidity to find where customers cannot get cash.

CHEQUE CLEARING

- **Zambia: Mobile Money Opened Doors. Fintech Has to Go Further** — The Fintech Times, 5 September 2026

  A Fintech Times analysis says Zambia had about 14.7 million registered mobile-money accounts in 2024, according to IMF data, up from around one adult in five holding any account in 2011. It argues fintech now needs to extend savings and credit, and notes the Bank of Zambia's phase-out of cheques, with banks no longer issuing cheque books since March 2025.

REGISTERED MOBILE MONEY ACCOUNTS AND THEIR USE

- **Zambia: Mobile Money Opened Doors. Fintech Has to Go Further** — The Fintech Times, 5 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

MOBILE-MONEY CASH-OUT AT A COMMERCIAL BANK'S ATMS

- **MoMo, FNB launch Zambia ATM cash-out** — ITWeb Africa, 17 September 2026

  MTN MoMo and FNB launched a service in Zambia letting mobile-money customers withdraw from their wallets at the bank's ATMs without a card or an account at that bank. It extends a partnership that already carried transfers between wallets and bank accounts and wallet payments at the bank's terminals.

DIRECT RENMINBI SETTLEMENT THROUGH CIPS (STANBIC BANK ZAMBIA)

- **Zambia says RMB payment system can cut trade costs, deepen China investment** — Zambia Monitor, 23 September 2026

  Stanbic Bank Zambia launched direct renminbi settlement for Zambia–China trade through China's Cross-Border Interbank Payment System in Lusaka on 23 September 2026. Zambia's commerce permanent secretary Lillian Bwalya said it would cut currency-conversion and intermediary costs and support Chinese investment in mining, manufacturing and infrastructure.

ZAMPAY AND THE GOVERNMENT ELECTRONIC PAYMENT GATEWAY

- **Zamportal revenue crosses $500m mark** — ITWeb Africa, 1 October 2026

  Zambia's finance minister said the national services portal has collected about K9.8 billion across 572 services and 52 providers since 2019. The 2027-2029 budget call circular names the Government Service Bus and payment gateway as the state's centralised revenue-collection system.

Registries

CONTINUOUS CIVIL REGISTRATION COVERAGE

- **Zambia : Govt. Implements Digital Civil Registration** — Lusaka Times, 3 September 2026

  Zambia's Department of National Registration, Passport and Citizenship said on 3 September 2026 that its Lavushimanda district office in Muchinga Province had registered more than 3,000 children under five in the previous four months. Registration runs on the Integrated National Registration Information System, deployed to 26 district offices in March 2022.

Sectoral management information systems

KEEPING GIRLS IN SCHOOL DIGITAL BENEFICIARY VERIFICATION

- **Government Trains 25 Teachers In KGS Digital Checklist Verification** — Lusaka Times, 24 September 2026

  Zambia's education ministry has trained 25 guidance teachers in Lavushimanda District to verify Keeping Girls in School beneficiaries on a tablet app instead of paper forms, under the GEWEL project. The girls are captured and sign on the tablet themselves; the training is run three times a year.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SMART OFFICE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

- **SC encourages Smart Office platform utilisation** — Lusaka Times, 4 September 2026

  Zambia's Secretary to the Cabinet, Patrick Kangwa, directed all government institutions to adopt the Smart Office Platform and told the Smart Zambia Institute to report on onboarding by the end of October 2026. He spoke at the handover of the system to Zambia Airports Corporation at Chongwe; officials said it automates workflows and electronic records.

- **ZACL Becomes First State-Owned Enterprise to Adopt SMART Office** — Efficacy News, 5 September 2026

  Zambia Airports Corporation became the first state-owned enterprise onboarded onto the government's SMART Office Management System, handed over by Secretary to Cabinet Patrick Kangwa on 4 September 2026 at Kenneth Kaunda International Airport. All head-office staff have been trained, and a further 406 employees at other stations are to be trained by the end of November 2026.

TENDERS PUBLISHED THROUGH ELECTRONIC PROCUREMENT

- **Zambia's 103,326 Tenders Reveal the Scale of the Government Procurement Market** — Solwezi Today, 14 September 2026

  Zambia published 103,326 tenders on its electronic government procurement system in 2025, up from 45,724 in 2024, according to the Zambia Public Procurement Authority's annual report. The system has recorded 173,428 tenders since 2016. An economist attributes much of the rise to electronic procurement becoming mandatory from April 2025.

PUBLIC SERVICE FUNERAL SCHEME DIGITAL PLATFORM

- **Funeral Scheme Digital Platform To Be Rolled Out In October** — Lusaka Times, 24 September 2026

  Zambia's Public Service Management Division said its funeral scheme for public servants, run with Madison Life Insurance, will move to a digital platform in the first week of October 2026, reported on 24 September. Members will be able to update details, register family members and track claims by phone or computer, with Chinsali among the first districts for awareness meetings. No cost is given.

INTEGRATED MEDIA REPORTING SYSTEM (IMRS)

- **Govt. Launches Integrated Media Reporting System** — Lusaka Times, 25 September 2026

  Zambia's Ministry of Information and Media launched an Integrated Media Reporting System, built in-house, to bring its institutions' reporting onto one platform, reported on 25 September 2026. It will track the eight presidential priorities for the Presidential Delivery Unit and El Niño-related matters. No cost or rollout date is given.

ZAMPORTAL

- **Zamportal revenue crosses $500m mark** — ITWeb Africa, 1 October 2026

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

DIGITAL CLIMATE ADVISORY SERVICE

- **How Zambia is building a digital climate advisory service its farmers can act on - TomorrowNow** — TomorrowNow, 6 October 2026

> Zambia's meteorological department and Ministry of Agriculture began building a Digital Climate Advisory Service in late 2025 with TomorrowNow, sending farmers SMS advice tuned to four-by-four-kilometre squares. The department's director said it reached about 35,000 farmers last season in seven local languages and aims for one million next season, adding three crops and livestock.

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

Rural digital data capture

> CONNECTIVITY AND DIGITAL LEARNING PROGRAMME FOR 70 SCHOOLS

- **Government launches Digital Learning programme** — Lusaka Times, 15 September 2026

  Zambia's government and Ignite Access launched a three-year programme on 15 September 2026 to connect 70 schools to Starlink satellite internet and fit solar power where schools are off the grid. Ignite Access will provide equipment and data free in the first year. Government targets 66% electricity access and 80% internet access by 2031.

Technology

AI

AI

> COUNTRY-HOSTED AI COMPUTE (UNDP AI INFRASTRUCTURE ACTIVATION)

- **Local AI compute infrastructure in Africa: Lessons from six country-hosted deployments on governance and effective use** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), Regional Bureau for Africa, 17 September 2026 KENYA MALAWI RWANDA SOUTH AFRICA TOGO AFRICA

  The UN Development Programme's Africa bureau published lessons on 17 September 2026 from the AI computing capacity it deployed in Kenya, Malawi, Rwanda, South Africa, Togo and Zambia. It identified 21 AI applications across the six, and found that data readiness, skills, institutional ownership and financing, not hardware, determine how far the compute is used.

> NJILA.AI CAREER-GUIDANCE PLATFORM

- **Zambia Pilots AI Career Guidance Platform to Bridge Youth Skills Gap** — Tech Africa News, 12 October 2026

  Zambia's technology ministry is piloting Njila.ai, an artificial-intelligence career-guidance platform, in the technical and vocational training system under a World Bank-backed skills project. The pilot is expected to reach more than 17,000 young people, and feedback is to decide any wider rollout.

Inclusion

Access to services · Digital divides

Access to services

> ENTRY-LEVEL HOME FIBRE PRICE

- **Liquid Zambia cuts fibre entry price to K300 and increases speeds** — Efficacy News, 16 September 2026

  Liquid Intelligent Technologies Zambia cut its entry home fibre package to K300 a month for up to 6 Mbps and raised speeds on its other plans at unchanged prices. The company puts Zambian internet penetration at 33% without giving a source.

MYZAMTEL SUPER APP AND KONGOLA MALAITI FINANCIAL SERVICE

- **Zamtel unveils MyZamtel Super App and two Zambia-first digital innovations** — Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026

  Zambia's Zamtel launched a self-care application with a build-your-own-bundle option, and Kongola Malaiti, a digital financial service reached by short code. No user figures are given.

Digital divides

CONNECTIVITY AND DIGITAL LEARNING PROGRAMME FOR PUBLIC SCHOOLS

- **70 Zambian Public Schools to Receive Starlink Connectivity Under Three-Year Programme** — Efficacy News, 18 September 2026

  Zambia launched a three-year programme to connect an initial 70 public schools by satellite, with solar power for schools off the grid, run by the presidential delivery unit with private partners. No cost or school list is stated.

Data

Open data · Use of satellite data

Open data

ZAMBIA NATIONAL RESEARCH REPOSITORY

- **Finance Ministry, ZamStats and UNICEF Launch National Research Repository** — Efficacy News, 17 September 2026

  Zambia's Ministry of Finance and National Planning, the Zambia Statistics Agency and UNICEF launched the Zambia National Research Repository, a central digital platform for research, evaluations and other knowledge products previously held in hard copy or scattered across institutions. Officials linked it to Vision 2030. No platform address, holdings figure or count of contributing institutions is given.

Use of satellite data

MYTOCHONDRIA SOIL-MONITORING PLATFORM

- **Zambian Entrepreneur Thomas Lungu Brings AI and Satellite Data to Farming** — wearetech.africa, 22 September 2026

  Zambian start-up Mytochondria, co-founded in 2023 by data scientist Thomas Fred Lungu, uses satellite imagery and AI to assess soil quality, moisture and temperature for farmers. The profile presents it as a response to climate shocks hitting harvests in southern Africa.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities · India activities

US / hyperscaler activities

UNITED STATES HEALTH FINANCING MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING

- **Zambia Ready To Sign US$1.5 Billion US Health Deal After Specimen-Sharing Clause Is Dropped** — Lusaka Times, 6 October 2026

Zambia's health minister said the five-year health memorandum with the United States is finalised and due for signature this week, after negotiators removed a clause requiring Zambia to share specimens from its disease-surveillance system. The revised text also addresses health data, intellectual property and benefit sharing; this account puts US funding at US$1.5 billion over five years, tapering annually, and an opposition party wants the final text published before signing.

- **Zambia, US finalise $3.6 billion health deal after public outcry over contentious clauses** — Zambia Monitor, 6 October 2026

  A second account of the Zambian health minister's briefing puts the money to be mobilised for the sector at US$3.6 billion and gives Thursday as the signing day. The minister said the contested clauses on data protection, intellectual property, benefit sharing and specimens have all been reviewed, and that the specimen-sharing obligation is gone entirely.

- **U.S., Zambia sign $2.49-billion health financing pact after removing data and specimen-sharing terms** — Los Angeles Times, 8 October 2026

  Zambia and the United States signed their five-year health financing memorandum in Lusaka after clauses on specimen sharing and patient data were removed. The State Department put it at US$2.49 billion, US$1.52 billion from the United States and US$975 million from Zambia, and Zambia said minerals were not part of it.

- **Zambia and US Sign Five-Year Health MOU and Data Sharing Agreement — Open Zambia** — Open Zambia, 8 October 2026

  Zambia and the United States signed a five-year health memorandum and a data sharing agreement. On this account the agreement exchanges only aggregated, de-identified programme data, with Zambia keeping ownership under its own laws; the health minister said the money will fund 40,000 health workers.

HEALTH DATA SHARING AGREEMENT WITH THE UNITED STATES

- **Zambia and US Sign Five-Year Health MOU and Data Sharing Agreement — Open Zambia** — Open Zambia, 8 October 2026

  Summarised under US / hyperscaler activities.

India activities

INDIA DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE LEARNING MISSION

- **Karnataka Hosts African Union, Five African Nations For Digital Public Infrastructure Exposure Visit** — The Bengaluru Live, 1 September 2026 ETHIOPIA MALAWI RWANDA SIERRA LEONE

  The Indian state of Karnataka hosted officials from the African Union, Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia on 1 September 2026, on a UNDP-supported visit to study digital public infrastructure. State officials and the Centre for e-Governance briefed the delegation on digitising public services and interoperability between government systems.

- **African Delegations Explore India's Digital Public Infrastructure During UNDP Learning Mission** — Youth Village Zambia, 2 September 2026 ETHIOPIA MALAWI RWANDA SIERRA LEONE

  The UN Development Programme in India hosted delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia on a learning mission on digital public infrastructure in New Delhi, Pune and Bangalore in early September 2026. The visits covered Aadhaar digital identity, the Unified Payments Interface and DigiLocker, with meetings at India's identity authority, its national payments corporation and the health and agriculture ministries.

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